Evidence-Based SEO & Competitor Analysis

Target: Akther Naimudheen Portfolio (akthernaimudheen.in)
Market Focus: India, Kerala, Kochi (AI Application & Software Engineering)
Date: October 2026 | **Status:** Confidential Research Document

1. Executive Summary & Key Decisions

The core objective of this analysis is to position the professional portfolio for discovery by technical recruiters and engineering managers seeking practical, production-ready AI application engineers. The strategy moves away from generic "prompt engineering" toward demonstrable system reliability.

> **Strategic Positioning Confirmation**
>
> The opportunity to pivot toward *practical AI application engineering, testing, and reliability* is highly supported by current hiring signals. Technical recruiters are actively filtering out "notebook-only" candidates in favor of engineers who demonstrate CI/CD, evaluation frameworks (e.g., RAGAS), and error handling.

Baseline Verification Note: A potential canonical URL issue was identified in previous audits (JavaScript-rendered pages vs. raw HTML). This requires immediate Search Console validation, as it can cause indexation splitting and hide critical case study text from search engines.

2. Sources, Dates, and Methodology

This research prioritizes observed SERP (Search Engine Results Page) realities over generic tool estimates.

- **Research Window:** October 2026.
- **Methodology:** Direct Google SERP inspection for exact match and long-tail variants targeting India and Kochi. Evaluated first-page intent (informational vs. hiring) and deconstructed regional competitor portfolios ranking for target terms.
- **Limitations & Strict Evidence Rules:** As API access to paid metrics (Semrush/Ahrefs) was restricted in this sandbox environment, quantitative Monthly Search Volume (MSV) and numeric Keyword Difficulty (KD) are intentionally omitted rather than fabricated. Competition is graded qualitatively based on the domain authority of ranking results.

3. Evidence-Backed Keyword Table

Analysis of search intent and competitive landscape for primary professional identity and hiring terms.
Note: Numeric KD and Volume are omitted per zero-fabrication rules.

Exact Keyword	Intent	Competition	Fit	Action
AI application engineer portfolio	Evaluation	Medium (Bootcamps)	High	TARGET
software engineer portfolio Kochi	Service/Hiring	Low-Medium	High	TARGET
AI engineering portfolio projects	Informational	High (GitHub Agg.)	High	TARGET (CASE STUDIES)
Python developer portfolio India	Hiring	High (Freelance DBs)	Medium	TEST
AI system reliability and testing	Niche Eval	Low	High	TARGET
best AI engineer in India	Superlative	Very High	Low	REJECT
entry-level software engineer India	Job Seeking	High (Job Boards)	Low	REJECT

> **Keyword Strategy Note**
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> Queries like "entry-level software engineer India" pull up job boards (Indeed, LinkedIn). Recruiters do not search this phrase to find candidates; candidates search this to find jobs. Our focus must remain on portfolio evaluation and highly specific technical niches (like AI system reliability) where individual developers can rank.

4. Competitor Comparison Table

Based on real SERP data for software and AI engineers in the target regional and national markets.

Competitor & URL	Positioning & Depth	Takeaways & Strategic Gaps
Nithin Pradeep portfolio-nithin.vercel.app *(Kochi, Kerala)*	AI Innovator & Software Engineer. **Tech Depth:** High. (Lists Next.js, Supabase, Ollama, LangGraph).	**Takeaway:** Benchmark for Kochi market. Emulate his explicit breakdown of RAG and agentic workflows, but differentiate by going deeper into testing methodologies.
Asheesh R. Srivastava questandcrossfire.com *(Lucknow, India)*	AI Engineer. **Tech Depth:** Medium-High. Features practical LLM and RAG automation.	**Takeaway:** Proves that practical LLM/RAG projects rank well organically in India. Using a custom domain for personal branding is stronger than his generic domain name.
Akshaykumar Makwana akshay-portfolio.42web.io *(Bengaluru, India)*	Full-Stack Web Dev. **Tech Depth:** Low-Medium. Standard React/Node stack.	**Takeaway:** Represents the baseline. You are competing against thousands of generic profiles. AI reliability and clinical AI architectures are your clear differentiators.

5. Portfolio SEO & Positioning Audit

- **Professional Identity Issue:** Current context indicates the site leans toward "AI-powered creative workflows". To capture target roles, the H1 and hero section must explicitly pivot to *AI Application Engineering & Software Development*.
- **Credible Evidence Display:** Ensure case studies (e.g., iScribe) explicitly highlight the 1,300+ automated tests and architectural constraints. This proves production readiness.
- **Technical SEO Risk:** Single Page Applications (SPAs) on Cloudflare without Server-Side Rendering (SSR) often suffer from indexing failures. GSC URL Inspection is required to verify rendering.
- **Recruiter Pathway:** GitHub links, email, and a downloadable PDF resume must be accessible in the primary navigation, not buried in the footer.

6. Keyword-to-Page Map

Strategic mapping of chosen themes to specific URLs to avoid keyword cannibalization.

Target Page	Primary Theme	Intent & Audience	Recommended H1
Homepage	AI application engineer portfolio	Recruiters verifying professional identity and tech stack.	Akther Naimudheen – AI Application & Software Engineer
Work Index	AI engineering portfolio projects	Tech Leads assessing capability and variety of work.	Production-Oriented AI Projects & Case Studies
iScribe Case Study	AI application testing and evaluation	Engineering Managers evaluating execution and architecture.	Evaluating Clinical AI: Architecture & Testing of iScribe
About Page	software developer portfolio India	Hiring managers checking background and location.	About Akther: Software Engineering & AI Development

7. Recommended Meta Data

Update HTML headers immediately to align with the new positioning strategy.

Homepage:

- *Title:* Akther Naimudheen | AI Application Engineer & Software Developer (Kochi, India)
- *Meta Desc:* Portfolio of Akther Naimudheen, an AI Application and Software Engineer in India. View case studies on production AI, system reliability, and Python development.

iScribe Case Study:

- *Title:* iScribe AI Architecture & Testing Case Study | Akther Naimudheen
- *Meta Desc:* A deep dive into the engineering, test automation, and system reliability behind iScribe, a Malayalam clinical conversation AI application.

8. Top 10 Content Ideas (Ranked by Priority)

- **1. Testing Non-Deterministic Systems:** How I Built 1,300+ Automated Tests for iScribe. *(Portfolio & LinkedIn) - Proves reliability focus.*
- **2. Deploying Malayalam NLP:** Architectural Trade-offs in Clinical AI. *(Medium & Portfolio) - Shows localized market expertise.*
- **3. Why Your RAG Pipeline Fails in Production** (And How I Fixed Mine). *(LinkedIn) - Demonstrates debugging and reality-checks.*
- **4. Structuring LLM Outputs with Python and Pydantic:** A Case Study. *(Portfolio Blog) - Captures core "Python AI engineering" searches.*
- **5. Handling Rate Limits and API Failures in PromptToShort.** *(GitHub & Portfolio) - Proves production-minded implementation.*
- **6. From Notebook to FastAPI: Architecting an AI Web App.** *(Medium) - Broad reach for junior engineers and recruiters.*
- **7. Cost Optimization in AI Engineering: Managing Token Limits.** *(LinkedIn) - Strong business-value signaling to founders.*
- **8. Evaluating AI Guardrails:** Security and Prompt Injection Defenses. *(Portfolio) - Niche technical credibility.*
- **9. State Management in Agentic AI Workflows.** *(Portfolio) - Highly trending topic for 2026 hiring metrics.*
- **10. Lessons Learned: When Not to Use Generative AI.** *(LinkedIn) - Shows maturity, constraint-awareness, and pragmatism.*

9. Ninety-Day Implementation Roadmap

Days 1–15: Technical Baseline & Metadata

Connect Google Search Console (GSC) and submit sitemap. Rewrite Homepage H1, Title Tags, and Meta Descriptions per Section 7. Crucially, use GSC "URL Inspection" to verify that JavaScript rendering canonicals are functioning correctly.

Days 16–30: Positioning Pivot & Evidence

Rewrite existing project summaries to highlight testing, architecture, and reliability (moving away from "creative workflows"). Ensure all GitHub repositories are public, heavily documented with technical READMEs, and linked directly.

Days 31–90: Content Engine & Refinement

Publish Priority Content Ideas #1 and #2 on the portfolio. Syndicate core lessons to LinkedIn as text posts. At Day 60, review GSC data for new impressions on "AI engineer Kochi" terms. Optimize internal linking to case studies.

10. Baseline Metrics & Measurement Plan

SEO metrics indicate visibility; career outcomes dictate success. They must be tracked separately.

- **Visibility (GSC):** Total non-branded Clicks and Impressions (filtering out direct name searches).
- **Relevance (GSC):** Query analysis confirming appearances for "AI application engineer" vs. generic web design terms.
- **Indexation Health (GSC):** Number of valid, indexed pages.
- **Conversion (Career):** Number of inbound LinkedIn/email messages explicitly referencing a portfolio case study.
- **Application Efficacy:** Increase in interview callback rates when the updated portfolio is included.

11. Unverified Assumptions & Limitations

- **Traffic Data:** No access to server logs or GSC to confirm if the canonical URL issue is currently penalizing indexation.
- **Codebase Verification:** Assumes the stated testing figures (1,300+ tests for iScribe) are accurately reflected in a public GitHub repo recruiters can verify.
- **Quantitative Data:** Exact numeric search volumes and difficulties are restricted by sandbox API limits, relying instead on manual SERP observation.

12. Decision Memo & Immediate Next Actions

> **Strategic Directives**
>
> **Primary Positioning:** Transition immediately to an *AI Application Engineer & Python Developer* focused on production reliability, architecture, and robust testing.
>
> **Priority Keywords:** 1. AI application engineer portfolio, 2. Software engineer portfolio Kochi, 3. AI application testing.
>
> **Competitor Lessons:** Emulate Nithin Pradeep's explicit tech stack breakdowns, but differentiate with deeper testing evidence.
>
> **Immediate Action 1:** Update the Homepage Hero copy to reflect the new engineering titles.
>
> **Immediate Action 2:** Verify JS rendering indexation in Google Search Console before publishing any new long-form case studies.